



Grade 5 Language Arts

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 5 · FULL YEAR

~12½ hrs per week · 150 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Grade 5 Language Arts is a yearlong reading and writing course built around six core novels, most of them historical fiction. Scholars analyze how authors develop character, perspective, and theme; write narratives, arguments, research pieces, and literary analysis; and deepen their command of Greek and Latin roots, word families, and academic vocabulary. The year is designed as the bridge into middle school: by spring, scholars analyze unfamiliar words, weigh sources, and defend claims with evidence on their own.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 **The Witch of Blackbird Pond** (Weeks 1–5)

Setting, conflict, and theme in colonial New England; scholars write a historically grounded narrative scene.

3 **Carry On, Mr. Bowditch** (Weeks 9–14)

Perseverance and navigation; scholars research, write an expository piece, and present it.

5 **How I Became a Ghost** (Weeks 19–25)

Narrator perspective and theme; scholars write literary analysis with embedded evidence.

7 **Year-End Synthesis** (Weeks 31–32)

A final synthesis essay comparing themes and perspectives across the year, plus a portfolio or presentation.

2 **Johnny Tremain** (Weeks 6–8)

Revolutionary Boston; scholars publish an argument essay with claim, reasons, evidence, and reasoning.

4 **Soft Rain** (Weeks 15–18)

The Cherokee removal, read with primary and secondary sources; scholars compare sources and write a historical argument.

6 **By the Great Horn Spoon!** (Weeks 26–30)

A Gold Rush adventure; scholars study humor and pacing, then publish their own adventure narrative.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Novel reading on a four-day cycle, about 1–2 chapters a day, with an analysis skill that grows more independent through the year.
- Morphology and vocabulary: Greek and Latin roots, affixes, word families, and how word parts connect to parts of speech.
- Grammar embedded in real reading and writing: sentence variety, clauses, punctuation, and careful editing.
- Writing connected to the reading: narrative, argument, research, literary analysis, and a final synthesis essay.

TIME COMMITMENT

750 minutes / week

≈ 2½ hours a day, Monday–Friday

- A typical day blends novel reading, word work, grammar, and writing.
- The scope and sequence plans four core ELA days each week; scheduled time also supports fluency practice, assessment, and review.
- Publishing weeks may run longer as drafts become final pieces.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A copy of each core novel (home, library, or school-provided; approved texts can vary by section).
- A reading and writing notebook, pencil, and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for typed and published writing.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.